The Referral-Growth CMO

Chief marketing officer (or head of sales) at an independent retail mortgage lender. Signs for Nomi; compliance and the GC can veto.



Stacy C., Chief Marketing Officer

Composite persona, anchored on the buyer interview (P9)

REPORTS TO	CEO; the CFO scrutinizes spend
OWNS	Brand, LO enablement, request queue
SPENDS ON	~$18K/yr Canva seats LOs barely use
MINDSET	Avoids any "headcount cut" talk

WHAT SHE'S MEASURED ON

- Referral-driven purchase volume
- LO productivity & satisfaction
- Brand consistency across LOs
- Clean compliance record

If you tell me LOs win more realtor partners, that's a sales budget conversation, and sales has money.

VP Marketing · buyer interview (P9)

JOB TO BE DONE

When rates and margins squeeze purchase volume, help me **grow referral business through the lender's loan officers** without adding headcount or putting non-compliant material on the street under the lender's name, so I can **defend my budget with revenue, not savings.**

VOICES SHE HEARS INSIDE THE LENDER

> Eight days for a flyer isn't a process, it's a punishment.
> Top-producer LO (P1)

> I'm not worried about the flyers that come through me. I'm worried about the ones that don't.
> Compliance analyst (P6)

> If the plan is to cut me, say it.
> Senior designer (P7)

KEY PAIN POINTS

19% URGENT REQUESTS ON TIME
Her queue misses the moments that win partners.
Median 6.5 business days for 4.1 hours of work.

37% LO-MADE ASSETS WITH A VIOLATION
Brand and compliance leak outside her control.
41% of LOs sent no requests in six months; they DIY.

0 ASSETS TIED TO A PARTNER
She can't prove marketing drives referrals.
Referrals are 74% of retail purchase apps.

2.1 /5 TOP-PRODUCER SATISFACTION
Her most valuable LOs are going around her.
Seven bypass it with a personal assistant or freelancer.

$0 NEW BUDGET
Every new tool is zero-sum.
"I'd have to kill something to fund something."

ACCOUNT PROFILE (ICP)

- **Independent retail lender,** branch LOs (pilot: ~150 LOs)
- **Purchase-heavy and referral-led**
- **Central marketing queue,** small creative team
- **In-house compliance** and a GC who owns the rules
- **Margin pressure:** rates above 7%, flat headcount

NOT A FIT NOW

- Wholesale/correspondent-only or call-center models with no branch LOs
- Refi-led books with little partner referral flow

BUYING COMMITTEE

SIGNS	VETO	CHAMPION	INFLUENCER
CMO or head of sales	**Compliance team & GC**	**Top-producer LOs**	**CEO / CFO**
Buys on referral growth, brand control, usage reporting	10% sampling for 6 months, examiner-ready audit log	Highest request volume, lowest satisfaction, most influence	Approves budget; hears "time saved" as "cut designers"

OBJECTIONS & HOW NOMI ANSWERS

"Will our GC approve AI review?"
Compliance pack: ruleset, per-asset audit trail, 10% human sampling. The GC sets the rules.

"Is this cutting designers?"
No. Nomi covers unplanned flyers the queue can't reach; designers keep planned work.

"Won't every flyer look alike?"
LO style profile plus partner co-branding, so each piece fits that partner.

HOW TO SELL TO HER

LEAD WITH

- Partners kept and won: referral revenue
- Reviewed draft in ~3 min, done in under 15
- Partner-tagged attribution she's never had

NEVER LEAD WITH

- "Saves your team time" (= headcount cut)
- Production cost savings as the headline
- "AI replaces compliance review"

TRIGGERS & WHERE TO REACH HER

- **Triggers:** audit finds LO-made material; a partner walks
- **Reach:** founder outreach, LinkedIn, HousingWire
- **Proof:** pilot case study, reference calls

VALIDATE NEXT (RISKIEST ASSUMPTIONS)

- **Willingness to pay** rests on one interview; "absolutely, if it works" is hypothetical
- **Who signs:** marketing, sales, or CEO? Referral framing may shift it to sales budget
- **Referral lift:** no data yet shows faster delivery changes partner behavior

Evidence: Module 2 discovery dataset (Harborline Home Lending, simulated course data): 9 interviews, queue export n=914, shadow-asset audit n=240, LO survey n=94, CRM baseline. Portrait is an illustration.